

NATURE OF RELIGIOUS LANGUAGE

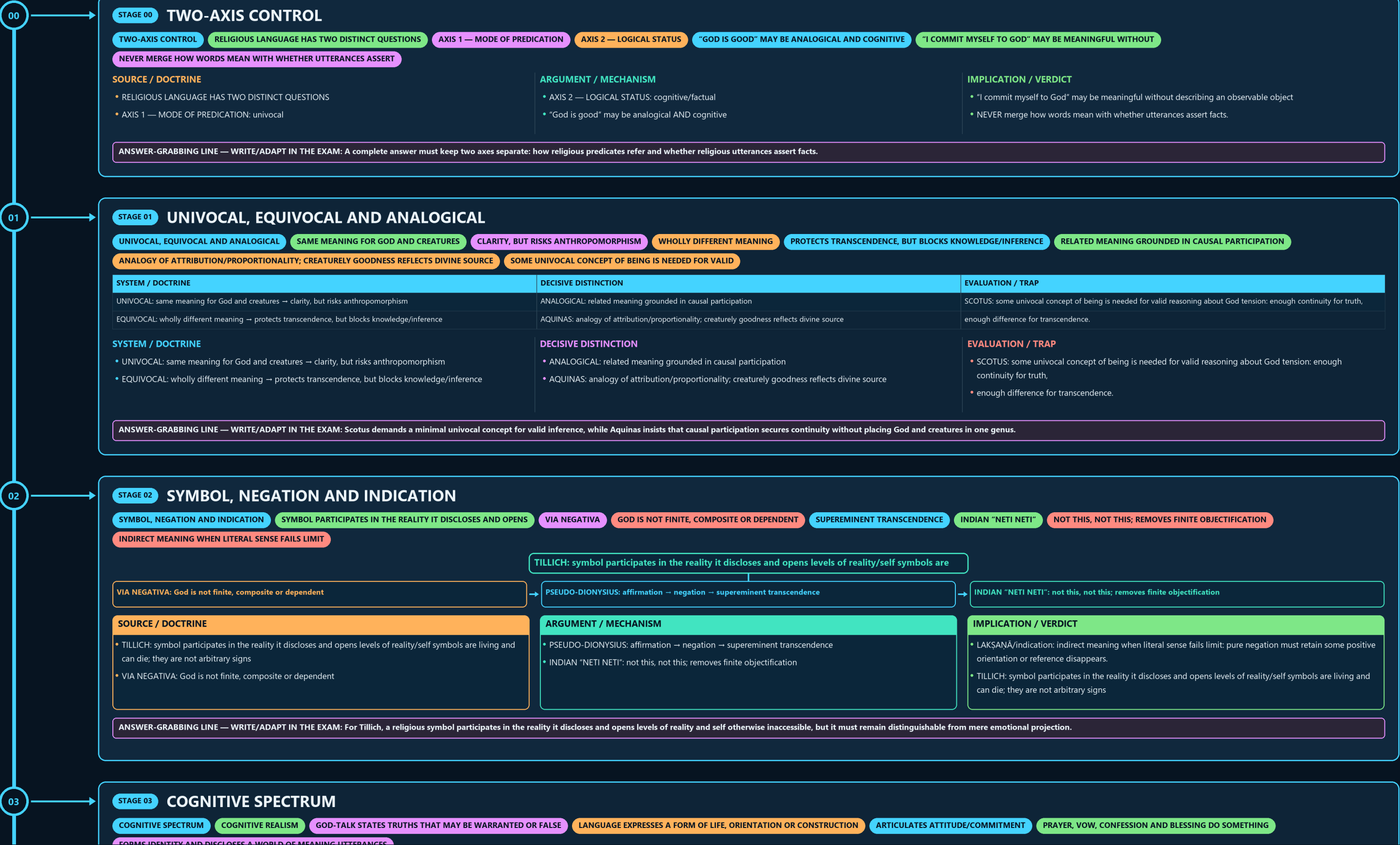
TWO-AXIS CONTROL – UNIVOCAL, EQUIVOCAL AND ANALOGICAL → SYMBOL, NEGATION AND INDICATION → COGNITIVE SPECTRUM → VERIFICATION AND FALSIFICATION → USE, SELF-INVOLVEMENT AND FORMS

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g11 repaired in place; prior artifacts unchanged outside the scoped current generation

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles



03

03

COGNITIVE SPECTRUM

COGNITIVE SPECTRUM

COGNITIVE REALISM

GOD-TALK STATES TRUTHS THAT MAY BE WARRANTED OR FALSE

LANGUAGE EXPRESSES A FORM OF LIFE, ORIENTATION OR CONSTRUCTION

ARTICULATES ATTITUDE/COMMITMENT

PRAYER, VOW, CONFESSION AND BLESSING DO SOMETHING

FORMS IDENTITY AND DISCLOSES A WORLD OF MEANING UTTERANCES

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	EVALUATION / TRAP
COGNITIVE REALISM: God-talk states truths that may be warranted or false	EXPRESSIVISM: articulates attitude/commitment	MYTHIC/NARRATIVE: forms identity and discloses a world of meaning utterances can have several functions
ANTI-REALISM/NON-REALISM: language expresses a form of life, orientation or construction	PERFORMATIVISM: prayer, vow, confession and blessing do something	functional richness does not itself settle reference.

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE

- COGNITIVE REALISM: God-talk states truths that may be warranted or false
- ANTI-REALISM/NON-REALISM: language expresses a form of life, orientation or construction

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

- EXPRESSIVISM: articulates attitude/commitment
- PERFORMATIVISM: prayer, vow, confession and blessing do something

EVALUATION / TRAP

- MYTHIC/NARRATIVE: forms identity and discloses a world of meaning utterances can have several functions
- functional richness does not itself settle reference.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: For Tillich, a religious symbol participates in the reality it discloses and opens levels of reality and self otherwise inaccessible, but it must remain distinguishable from mere emotional projection.

04

04

VERIFICATION AND FALSIFICATION

VERIFICATION AND FALSIFICATION

COGNITIVELY MEANINGFUL FACTUAL CLAIMS MUST BE ANALYTIC OR EMPIRICALLY

TRADITIONAL GOD-TALK APPEARS MEANINGLESS, NOT MERELY FALSE

ESCHATOLOGICAL VERIFICATION — CELESTIAL-CITY PARABLE; CONFIRMATION MAY OCCUR AFTER

BELIEVERS LET “GOD LOVES US” DIE BY A THOUSAND

RELIGIOUS BLIK IS UNFALSIFIABLE ORIENTATION YET MEANINGFUL

PARTISAN TRUSTS STRANGER DESPITE COUNTER-EVIDENCE; COMMITMENT REMAINS EVIDENTIALY TESTED

WHAT COUNTS AGAINST THE CLAIM, AND WHAT KIND OF

DOCTRINE / CLAIM	OBJECTION / PRESSURE	REPLY / RESIDUAL
- AYER: cognitively meaningful factual claims must be analytic or empirically verifiable - traditional God-talk appears meaningless, not merely false - HICK: eschatological verification — celestial-city parable; confirmation may occur after death	- FLEW: believers let “God loves us” die by a thousand qualifications - HARE: religious blik is unfalsifiable orientation yet meaningful - MITCHELL: partisan trusts stranger despite counter-evidence	commitment remains evidentially tested key test: what counts against the claim, and what kind of claim is it?

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The verification and falsification debates test whether religious claims exclude any possible state of affairs; a meaningful theology must specify evidential risk without demanding laboratory verification.

05

05

USE, SELF-INVOLVEMENT AND FORMS OF LIFE

USE, SELF-INVOLVEMENT AND FORMS OF LIFE

MEANING IS USE WITHIN A LANGUAGE-GAME AND FORM OF

RELIGIOUS ASSERTIONS EXPRESS INTENTION TO FOLLOW AN AGAPEISTIC WAY

SAME WORD, DIFFERENT GRAMMAR

“FATHER” BIOLOGICAL/SECULAR

“FATHER” RELATIONAL RELIGIOUS USE

“CREATION” TEMPORAL MANUFACTURE

DEPENDENCE ON ULTIMATE SOURCE OBJECTION

WITTGENSTEIN: meaning is use within a language-game and form of life prayer, lament, confession and

BRAITHWAITE: religious assertions express intention to follow an agapeistic way of life

SAME WORD, DIFFERENT GRAMMAR

“father” biological/secular

SOURCE / DOCTRINE	ARGUMENT / MECHANISM	IMPLICATION / VERDICT
- WITTGENSTEIN: meaning is use within a language-game and form of life prayer, lament, confession and worship are not failed scientific hypotheses - BRAITHWAITE: religious assertions express intention to follow an agapeistic way of life - SAME WORD, DIFFERENT GRAMMAR	“father” biological/secular “Father” relational religious use “creation” temporal manufacture	dependence on ultimate source objection: use may explain intelligibility, but cannot by itself guarantee truth or protect critique.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Religious and secular language share grammar, but religious use is distinguished by its ultimate referent, self-involving force, communal practice and resistance to exhaustive literalisation.

06

06

MYSTICISM, ADVAITA AND PLURALISM BRIDGES

MYSTICISM, ADVAITA AND PLURALISM BRIDGES

INEFFABILITY PRESSURES LITERAL DESCRIPTION; PARADOX AND SYMBOL POINT BEYOND

NIRGUṆA BRAHMAN BEYOND LIMITING PREDICATES; SAGUṆA LANGUAGE VALID EMPIRICALLY

DIFFERENT CONCEPTUAL SCHEMES MAY REFER TO OR CONSTRUCT DIVERSE

NATURE OF RELIGIOUS LANGUAGE • TILE 2/3 • same master rows 2527-5761 of 8288 • continues below

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- WITTGENSTEIN: meaning is use within a language-game and form of life prayer, lament, confession and worship are not failed scientific hypotheses
- BRAITHWAITE: religious assertions express intention to follow an agapeistic way of life
- SAME WORD, DIFFERENT GRAMMAR

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- “father” biological/secular
- “Father” relational religious use
- “creation” temporal manufacture

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- dependence on ultimate source objection: use may explain intelligibility, but cannot by itself guarantee truth or protect critique.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Religious and secular language share grammar, but religious use is distinguished by its ultimate referent, self-involving force, communal practice and resistance to exhaustive literalisation.

06

STAGE 06 MYSTICISM, ADVAITA AND PLURALISM BRIDGES

MYSTICISM, ADVAITA AND PLURALISM BRIDGES

INEFFABILITY PRESSURES LITERAL DESCRIPTION; PARADOX AND SYMBOL POINT BEYOND

NIRGUṆA BRAHMAN BEYOND LIMITING PREDICATES; SAGUṆA LANGUAGE VALID EMPIRICALLY

DIFFERENT CONCEPTUAL SCHEMES MAY REFER TO OR CONSTRUCT DIVERSE

TRANSLATION WITHOUT ERASING DOCTRINAL DIFFERENCE ANSWER

COMPARE REFERENCE, PREDICATION, FUNCTION AND LIFE-CONTEXT SEPARATELY.

MYSTICISM: ineffability pressures literal description; paradox and symbol point beyond concepts

ADVAITA: nirguṇa Brahman beyond limiting predicates

saguna language valid empirically mahāvākya interpretation uses implication to remove incompatible literal attributes

PLURALISM: different conceptual schemes may refer to or construct diverse ultimates challenge: translation without erasing

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- MYSTICISM: ineffability pressures literal description; paradox and symbol point beyond concepts
- ADVAITA: nirguṇa Brahman beyond limiting predicates

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- saguna language valid empirically mahāvākya interpretation uses implication to remove incompatible literal attributes
- PLURALISM: different conceptual schemes may refer to or construct diverse ultimates challenge: translation without erasing doctrinal difference answer

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- compare reference, predication, function and life-context separately.
- MYSTICISM: ineffability pressures literal description; paradox and symbol point beyond concepts

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Analogy preserves ordered similarity, symbol mediates participation and negation removes creaturely limitation; each seeks meaningful reference without literal anthropomorphism.

07

STAGE 07 PYQ ANSWER ARCHITECTURE

PYQ ANSWER ARCHITECTURE

IDENTIFY UTTERANCE

ANALYSE MODE OF PREDICATION

CLASSIFY LOGICAL STATUS

NAMED THEORY (AQUINAS/TILlich/AYER/FLEW/HARE/MITCHELL/WITTGENSTEIN)

STRONGEST OBJECTION/REPLY

INDIAN ANALOGY OR NEGATION BRIDGE

RELIGIOUS LANGUAGE NEED NOT BE LITERAL TO BE MEANINGFUL

IDENTIFY utterance → analyse mode of predication → classify logical status

named theory (Aquinas/Tillich/Ayer/Flew/Hare/Mitchell/Wittgenstein)

strongest objection/reply → Indian analogy or negation bridge → verdict

CLOSE: religious language need not be literal to be meaningful, but analogy, symbol, use or

adequacy requires semantic intelligibility, critical vulnerability and lived function.

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- IDENTIFY utterance → analyse mode of predication → classify logical status
- named theory (Aquinas/Tillich/Ayer/Flew/Hare/Mitchell/Wittgenstein)

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- strongest objection/reply → Indian analogy or negation bridge → verdict
- CLOSE: religious language need not be literal to be meaningful, but analogy, symbol, use or commitment cannot automatically secure factual truth

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- adequacy requires semantic intelligibility, critical vulnerability and lived function.
- IDENTIFY utterance → analyse mode of predication → classify logical status

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: A strong answer identifies the utterance’s function, applies the relevant theory, tests its strongest objection and closes with a qualified account of cognitive content.

E

EXTRA SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT

ADVANCED-DOSSIER RECONCILIATION — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]

DOCTRINE STATEMENT.

PREDICATES SUCH AS GOOD AND WISE APPLY TO GOD

(1) CREATURES DEPEND CAUSALLY ON GOD AND DISPLAY PERFECTIONS

(2) EFFECTS RESEMBLE CAUSES WITHOUT MATCHING THEIR MODE

(3) PERFECTION TERMS CAN THEREFORE SIGNIFY TRULY WHILE THEIR

PRESUPPOSITION. CAUTION

OPTIONAL SOURCE WITNESS

- Advanced-dossier reconciliation — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]
- Doctrine statement.
- Predicates such as good and wise apply to God neither in exactly the creaturely sense nor in a wholly unrelated sense, but analogically.
- Argument.

ADVANCED OBJECTION

- (1) Creatures depend causally on God and display perfections
- (2) effects resemble causes without matching their mode
- (3) perfection terms can therefore signify truly while their mode of possession differs infinitely.
- Presupposition. CAUTION: Causal participation warrants semantic continuity and pure perfections can be separated from creaturely limitation.

COMPARATIVE NUANCE

- Distinction.
- Analogy of attribution relates secondary instances to a primary source
- proportionality compares relations according to distinct modes of being.
- Canonical example.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.